

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 550

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend R. Larry Smith of Knox County for decades of devoted service to the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is R. Larry Smith of Knox County, a consummate professional whose service to his community and this State have improved the well-being of countless individuals and organizations; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Smith earned a Bachelor of Science degree in Wildlife and Fisheries Science from the University of Tennessee, Knoxville (UT) and went on to work with the Tennessee Valley Authority Fisheries and Wildlife Management Division and then the Tennessee Wildlife Resources Agency (TWRA); and

WHEREAS, a TWRA Foundation Member, R. Larry Smith certified more than 500 graduates as a hunter safety instructor during his tenure with the TWRA, and he served as the commissioner of the Tennessee Department of Environment and Conservation from 2001 to 2004; and

WHEREAS, in 1980, he founded R. Larry Smith & Associates Insurance Agency, thus embarking upon a remarkable career as an insurance agency director; he would ascend to serve as president of the Knoxville Association of Insurance and Financial Advisors and Tennessee State president of the National Association of Insurance and Financial Advisors; and

WHEREAS, his career in insurance garnered LUTCF designation, the National Quality Award (over four decades), the National Sales Achievement Award (over three decades), the

Leadership in Life Institute Award, and the National Association of Insurance and Financial Advisors Insurance Professional of the Year Award for the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, R. Larry Smith was commissioner of the Metropolitan Planning Commission of Knox County in 1997-2005 and a Knox County Commissioner in 2006-2014, serving as vice chair in 2012 and 2013; long an engaged supporter of the Republican Party, he was chairman of the Knox County GOP in 1992-1994; and

WHEREAS, a venerated leader throughout his community, Mr. Smith lent his time and talents as a member of various organizations, serving on the boards of the American Cancer Society, the American Red Cross, Tennova Hospital, Knoxville Volunteer Rescue Squad, the YMCA, Keep Knoxville Beautiful, James White Fort, the Helen Ross McNabb Center, the Boys & Girls Club of Knoxville, and CareCuts, Inc., a nonprofit serving the homeless population in Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, he has further served as a member of the Truist Bank Advisory Board, TDS Telecom Advisory Board, Knox County Community Health Improvement Council, Rural Metro Fire Advisory Board, UT Knoxville's Alumni Board and Tip-Off Club, Knoxville Sertoma Center's Business Advisory Committee, Better Roads in North Knoxville (BRINK), and Better Business Bureau; and

WHEREAS, an Eagle Scout himself, R. Larry Smith has been actively involved with the Boy Scouts of America for nearly sixty years, serving in various leadership roles, including as an assistant Scoutmaster and member of the Smoky Mountain Council Board, and receiving several honors, including the Silver Beaver Award and the James A. West Fellowship Award; and

WHEREAS, his other duly awarded honors include being named Man of the Year by the Halls Business and Professional Association, receiving the Service to Mankind Award from the

Sertoma Club and the East Tennessee Historical Society Award of Distinction, and earning an Honorary Letterman from the University of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, R. Larry Smith has been a member of Fountain City United Methodist Church for more than three decades, during which time he has taught Sunday School and served on various councils and committees; and

WHEREAS, throughout his many worthy endeavors, Mr. Smith has enjoyed the love and support of his wife, Sharon, and their three children, and four grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, R. Larry Smith epitomizes the spirit and commitment that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud Mr. Smith for his many years of dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend R. Larry Smith for his distinguished career in the insurance industry and his many years of public service and leadership, extending our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.